

Document 16: Osteoporosis - Causes and Prevention

Osteoporosis is a skeletal disorder characterized by decreased bone strength and increased risk of fractures. It is most common in postmenopausal women but can affect men and younger individuals. Risk factors include aging, hormonal changes, low calcium and vitamin D intake, sedentary lifestyle, smoking, and excessive alcohol use. Prevention and management include weight-bearing exercise, adequate calcium and vitamin D intake, avoiding tobacco and excess alcohol, and medications such as bisphosphonates. Early diagnosis with bone density testing can help prevent fractures.